by G. Evelyn Hutchinson, but it was decades before there was a scientific consensus on the human-made causes of climate change.

The future

Modern ecology has come a long way since the science was first recognized. It now draws on many disciplines. In addition to zoology, botany, and their microdisciplines, it relies on geology, geomorphology, climatology, chemistry, physics, genetics, sociology, and more. Furthermore, the importance of the knowledge held by indigenous peoples and local communities is finally being recognized, and their voices are beginning to be heard on the global stage. Ecology influences local and national government decisions about urbanization, transportation, industry, and economic growth. The challenges posed by climate change, rising sea levels, habitat destruction, the extinction of species, plastic and other forms of pollution, and a looming water crisis pose serious threats to human civilization. They demand radical policy responses based on sound science. Ecology will provide the answers. It is up to governments to apply them.

“Even in the vast and mysterious reaches of the sea we are brought back to the fundamental truth that nothing lives to itself.”

Rachel Carson

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